William Glasser



Glasser believes that to improve instruction and classroom management to change the way a classroom functions. He views students as being responsible for their own misbehavior, believing they consciously choose how to act. According to Glasser, teachers have the ability to guide students toward better behavioral decisions. His approach centers on creating a curriculum that naturally engages students and collaborating with them in ways that promote responsible choices, ultimately fostering their responsible choices that lead to personal success.

Overview of Noncoercive Discipline

Glasser emphasizes the importance of quality in curriculum, teaching, and learning. Instead of trying to force students to learn or behave in specific ways which he believes is ineffective, schools should recognize that students naturally engage with subjects that interest them and fulfill their needs for security, belonging, power, fun, and freedom. Glasser views these needs as fundamental, deeply rooted in our genetics. By sincerely addressing these needs, educators can encourage students to participate in meaningful learning and behave appropriately without applying any pressure.

Strategy & Examples

1: Open Communication

.Teacher is a guide in helping students make good choices. This supports Choice Theory by helping them learn to make effective choices that meet their needs.

Ex. Classroom Meetings

The teacher and students will discuss class matters and resolve problems. This helps students have a sense of belonging, take responsibility, and solve problems through open communication

2. Have quality curriculum and instruction

Humans gravitate to things that make them happy and that interest them so by making the curriculum relevant to them and their everyday lives.

Ex. in lower grades, word problems can include students' names, or in higher grades, project–based learning (PBL) can involve real–world tasks like community projects. The curriculum should go beyond rote memorization, focusing instead on helping students understand how the material connects to their lives and how they can apply it in the future.

3. Build Rapport with Students

Building strong relationships with students is essential, as it encourages them to openly share any issues they may face. Students should view you as a provider of valuable education rather than as an authoritarian or enforcer.

Ex. Replace traditional discipline with talking and listening to students as soon as you see a possible conflict or misbehavior Listen carefully. Inject humor into the situation if you can. This helps students build trust.

Works Cited

Charles, C. M., Senter, G. W. (2005). Building Classroom Discipline. United Kingdom: Pearson/Allyn & Bacon. (p.73–91)